

IBM Brand Style Guide

IBM-inspired report presentation guide. Use this specimen to see how IBM-styled reports present report components for evidence, governance, implementation, and executive decision-making.

IBM styling is structured, modular, technical, and explicit. The report should feel like a trustworthy system: clear grids, precise labels, accessible contrast, and rigorous component states.

IBM style manifest

Brand: IBM	Report mode: structured enterprise evidence report
Shape language: modular grid, clear rules, restrained surfaces	Primary accent: IBM blue
Evidence grammar: explicit labels, source IDs, confidence and status	Best use: technical audits, architecture reports, governance, compliance

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1. 1. Foundation tokens

1.1 Neutral canvas

Use white and cool greys to create a stable enterprise workspace. Purpose: make complex information feel orderly.

1.2 Blue system accent

Use blue for active states, links, selected navigation, and information emphasis. Purpose: signal system action and trust.

1.3 Rule-based structure

Use visible grid lines, table rules, and panel boundaries. Purpose: classification and comparison stay clear.

1.4 Status palette

Use accessible red, amber, blue, and green states with text labels. Purpose: enterprise reports must remain understandable in grayscale and print.

1.5 Display hierarchy

Use clear sans-serif headings with systematic scale. Purpose: let structure, not ornament, carry authority.

1.6 Body copy

Use direct sentences, strong labels, and predictable spacing. Purpose: technical readers can scan quickly.

1.7 Code and metadata

Use mono for IDs, commands, source keys, and implementation references. Purpose: operational evidence remains precise.

1.8 Tables

Tables are first-class IBM components. Purpose: enterprise decisions often depend on stable rows, columns, and comparison logic.

2. 2. Report element index

01 — Foundations — tokens, type, grid, status

02 — Notifications — severity, information, evidence, action

03 — Data — KPI cards, tables, bars, ledgers

04 — Recommendations — priority cards, brief, checklist

05 — Governance — source cards, code, privacy

DESIGN RULE: classify the evidence, state the decision, and show the verification path.

▲ **Action Prompt**

COPYABLE ACTION PROMPT



Reference this report action: Design rule: classify the evidence, state the decision, and show the verification path.

Guide me through the tools, resources, accounts, permissions, source material, and access needed to take this action. Break the work into numbered steps, call out any missing inputs before execution, include safe handling for credentials or confidential data, and finish with verification evidence I can capture.

3. 3. Notification variations

EVIDENCE: VERIFIED

EVIDENCE: PARTIAL

EVIDENCE: INFERRED

EVIDENCE: MISSING

CRITICAL

HIGH

MEDIUM

LOW

3.1 Critical system state

Use for blockers, policy violations, inaccessible data, or missing verification. Shape: modular panel with explicit severity label.

3.2 Warning system state

Use for partial evidence, high-risk assumptions, or implementation dependencies. Include owner and next check.

3.3 Information system state

Use for method details, background, or architectural context. Keep it precise.

3.4 Verified system state

Use for completed controls, verified evidence, and stable patterns. Include source and date.

3.5 Evidence panel

Evidence panels explain source strength, confidence, and the claim supported. They should never mix facts with recommendations.

3.6 Action panel

Action panels convert evidence into owner, due date, acceptance criteria, and verification steps.

▲ Action Prompt

COPYABLE ACTION PROMPT



Reference this report action: 3.6 Action panel Action panels convert evidence into owner, due date, acceptance criteria, and verification steps.

Guide me through the tools, resources, accounts, permissions, source material, and access needed to take this action. Break the work into numbered steps, call out any missing inputs before execution, include safe handling for credentials or confidential data, and finish with verification evidence I can capture.

4. 4. Data block examples

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Components covered in this specimen.
Source: B001.

4

Severity states documented and labelled.
Source: B002.

100%

Tables include stable headers and row labels. Source: B003.

0

Unredacted private artifacts in the export.
Source: B004.

Component	Purpose	IBM treatment	Verification
Manifest	Scope and governance	Field grid with precise labels	All fields are present
Notification	System status	Label plus state colour	Meaning survives grayscale
Facts table	Dense comparison	Stable headers and rules	Columns fit print profile
Brief	Delivery control	Task, files, acceptance, verify	Worker can execute



B001 — Component inventory — High confidence; checks all rendered block families.

B002 — Severity review — High confidence; validates critical, high, medium, low states.

B003 — Table audit — High confidence; verifies headers, wrapping, and print fit.

B004 — Redaction audit — High confidence; confirms public-safe export.

5. 5. Recommendation and governance examples

5.1 Critical control gap

Use when a missing component, evidence field, or verification step blocks report approval. EVIDENCE: **VERIFIED**

Owner: Governance. Due: Current release. Source: B001.

5.2 High-priority dependency

Use when a recommendation depends on another system, owner, or evidence source. EVIDENCE: **PARTIAL**

Owner: Delivery. Due: Next sprint. Source: B002.

5.3 Medium optimisation

Use when the report is correct but can improve scanability, table density, or export fidelity. EVIDENCE: **INFERRED**

Owner: Design systems. Due: Backlog. Source: B003.

done

5.4 Completed control

Use for verified safeguards and implemented patterns. EVIDENCE: **VERIFIED**

Owner: QA. Verified: B004.

5.5 Preserve

- Explicit source IDs.
- Stable table columns.
- Clear owner and verification fields.

5.6 Avoid

- Ambiguous status labels.
- Decorative charts without data labels.
- Recommendations without acceptance criteria.

Task: Apply IBM-styled report components to a technical audit.

Files: report Markdown, renderer CSS, evidence ledger, PDF exports.

Acceptance: every finding maps to source IDs, confidence, owner, and verification.

Verification: run renderer validation, markdown lint, print export, and evidence-link review.

☒ Manifest states scope, owner, and redaction level.

☒ Tables include clear headers and evidence columns.

☐ Every priority card has acceptance criteria.

☐ Source cards link to redacted evidence stubs or secure storage notes.

6. 6. Code, source, and privacy examples

IBM-styled verification command

TEXT CODE

Validate: renderer source -> HTML -> A4 PDF -> source ledger -> owner checklist
Pass: every recommendation has evidence, owner, due date, acceptance, verification

6.1 Source-card purpose

Use source cards as governance records: source ID, type, observed date, claim supported, confidence, sensitivity, and storage location.

PUBLIC ARTIFACT RULE	IBM-styled public examples must not include private client names, URLs, local paths, screenshots, raw exports, or uncontrolled evidence excerpts.
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